

BITAQAT HIFD QOR'AN

Learning the Qur'an, step by step

The recitation card system

Teaching methodology and user guide



2026-2027 edition • cards divided by surah

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1. Introduction

The essentials in five lines

- Goal: memorise the last quarter of the Qur'an, from "Sabbih" to "Yâsîn", with a command of tajwîd.
- Means: one recitation card per student, setting an annual objective broken down into weekly objectives.
- Six levels, three categories: beginner, intermediate, advanced.
- Three stakeholders, equally accountable: the student, the parents, the teacher.
- Learning happens at home; the lesson is for reciting, validating and consolidating.

This document sets out the teaching methodology of the Bitaqat Hifd Qor'an project, together with instructions for using the recitation cards.

The project's ambition is to enable students to memorise a substantial portion of the Qur'an while mastering its recitation in accordance with the rules of tajwîd. By the end of the programme, the student should also have achieved full autonomy, allowing them to continue learning independently or within a more advanced course.

The stated objective of this methodology is the memorisation of the last quarter of the Qur'an — from "Sabbih" to "Yâsîn" inclusive — with a command of the rules of tajwîd.

This methodology is built on objective-based teaching and rests on three requirements: learning by objective, shared accountability, and monitoring. It involves three stakeholders: the student, the parents and the teacher. It is organised into six levels grouped in three categories: beginner, intermediate and advanced.

What has changed in this edition

Division by surah replaces division by hizb

The recitation cards used to be divided into "hizb". They are now divided into surahs: each surah forms a block identified by its name, and each box within the block corresponds to a range of verses to memorise for the week.

This division is clearer for student and parents alike: you always know which surah is under way, and a range of verses is found instantly in the Mushaf.

The hizb division has not disappeared for all that: it remains legible on the card. **The start of each hizb is marked by a double-bordered rectangle, and the hizb number is repeated in the margin.** Readers attached to the hizb division — particularly in the "Warsh" reading — therefore keep their bearings.

2. The three principles

2.1 Learning by objective

Setting an objective at the start of the year is essential for effectiveness. Throughout the programme, everyone involved — student, teacher and parents — must know at all times “where they are going” and “where they stand”. This is the condition for sound monitoring and tangible results.

Learning proceeds through short objectives to be met at home. Reciting and validating those objectives takes place in class, with the teacher. Step by step, knowledge accumulates; consolidating it happens in class.

2.2 Shared accountability

Everyone is accountable: not only the teacher, but also the student and the parents. The burden of learning falls on all three.

- The teacher sets the objectives, guides the student, monitors progress and validates what has been learnt.
- The student meets the objectives set.
- The parents, working with the teacher, help the student meet the objectives and monitor progress daily at home.

Parents play a decisive part here: the student's success depends largely on them.

2.3 Monitoring

Since learning happens mainly at home, parental monitoring is central. Parents contribute directly and personally to the success of the project, and must be strongly involved in the student's learning. They are direct contributors to it.

3. The recitation card

To put these three requirements into practice, and to help parents and student reach the goal set at the start of the year, a tracking-card system — the “recitation card” — is used.

3.1 What the card is for

The card is issued to each student and corresponds to one level. It sets an annual objective, broken down into short-term objectives. The student keeps it at all times and presents it to the teacher at every recitation. The teacher keeps a duplicate, allowing closer oversight and providing a copy should the card be lost.

Parents are asked to monitor progress. In practice the teacher writes a dated note, “see recitation card”, in the home-school notebook after each recitation. Parents must sign that note before the next recitation.

3.2 The front: the card's identity

The image shows the front of a recitation card for level 3. It is a rectangular card with a blue border. The top section is orange and contains the title 'بطاقة حفظ القرآن الكريم' (Quran Recitation Card) and 'N° 3'. Below this is a table with fields for 'Objectif', 'Nom', 'Prénom', 'Classe', and 'Professeur'. The 'Objectif' field contains 'تبارك'. To the right of the table is a section titled 'Fonctionnement' (Functioning) which explains the card's purpose and usage. At the bottom left, there is a field for the school year '20__ - 20__'. Numbered callouts 1 to 5 point to specific parts of the card: 1 points to the title, 2 to the 'Objectif' field, 3 to the student details fields, 4 to the school year field, and 5 to the 'Fonctionnement' section.

بطاقة حفظ القرآن الكريم	
N° 3	
1	2
Objectif	: تبارك
Nom	:
Prénom	:
3	3
Classe	:
Professeur	:
4	4
20__ - 20__	

5

Fonctionnement

Cette carte est attribuée à chaque élève et correspond à un niveau. L'élève la garde toujours en sa possession et la présente à son professeur à chaque récitation.

Elle définit un objectif annuel qui se décompose en soursates, elles-mêmes découpées en objectifs hebdomadaires.

A chaque objectif hebdomadaire correspond une case :

- Si l'objectif est atteint, c'est-à-dire que la section est bien récitée, le professeur valide la récitation en inscrivant la date dans la case.
- Si l'objectif n'est pas atteint, la case reste vierge. Une nouvelle échéance pour récitation est fixée avec l'élève.

Les cases en bout de ligne permettent des validations intermédiaires pour consolider les acquis. La carte se parcourt horizontalement, de la droite vers la gauche, du haut vers le bas.

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Figure 1: front of the recitation card (level 3)

- 1 The level number and its colour code: white, yellow, orange, green, blue and burgundy for levels 1 to 6.
- 2 The annual objective, given as the name of the surah to be reached — here “Tabâraka”.
- 3 The student's details: surname, first name, class and teacher's name.
- 4 The school year.
- 5 The instructions, printed on the card itself: student and parents always have them to hand.

3.3 The back: the memorisation path

The back carries the whole year's path, surah by surah. Each surah forms a self-contained block.

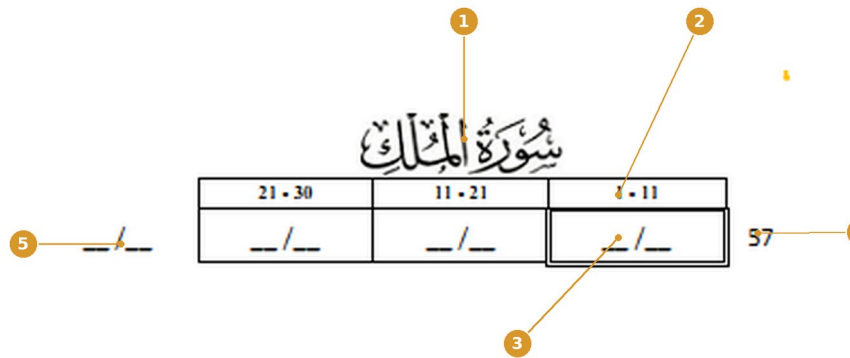


Figure 2: anatomy of a "surah" block (Surah Al-Mulk, level 3 card)

- 1 The surah name, at the head of the block.
- 2 The range of verses to memorise for the week — here verses 1 to 11.
- 3 The recitation box: the teacher writes the date in it once the section has been correctly recited.
- 4 The hizb number, repeated in the margin.
- 5 The end-of-line box: it validates the whole surah, once all its sections have been recited.

57	سُورَةُ الْقَاٰتِرَاتِ	39 - 52	21 - 39	1 - 21	57	سُورَةُ الْمُلْكِ	21 - 30	11 - 21	1 - 11	57
		— / —	— / —	— / —			— / —	— / —	— / —	
58	سُورَةُ الْمُحْكَمَاتِ	32 - 44	16 - 32	1 - 16	58	سُورَةُ الْفُجْرِ	32 - 52	14 - 32	1 - 14	58
		— / —	— / —	— / —			— / —	— / —	— / —	
59	سُورَةُ الْجِنِّ	19 - 28	10 - 19	1 - 10	59	سُورَةُ الْمُرْسَلَاتِ	21 - 28	9 - 21	1 - 9	59
		— / —	— / —	— / —			— / —	— / —	— / —	
60	سُورَةُ الْمُرْسَلَاتِ	39 - 56	27 - 39	1 - 27	60	سُورَةُ الْمُرْسَلَاتِ	19 - 20	11 - 19	1 - 11	60
		— / —	— / —	— / —			— / —	— / —	— / —	
61	سُورَةُ الْمُرْسَلَاتِ	34 - 50	19 - 34	1 - 19	61	سُورَةُ الْقِيَامَةِ	21 - 31	10 - 21	1 - 10	61
		— / —	— / —	— / —			— / —	— / —	— / —	

Figure 3: complete back of the recitation card (level 3)

3.4 How to read the card

Four reading rules

1. The card is read horizontally, from right to left, then from top to bottom — like an Arabic text.
2. Each block carries the name of a surah; you finish it before moving on to the next.
3. Within a block, start with the rightmost box: it holds the first verses.
4. One box = one weekly objective. The verse range is printed just above it.

These rules apply to all six cards of the programme. The reading direction is in any case restated on the front of every card: in case of doubt, that is what counts.

3.5 Spotting the hizb

The traditional hizb division remains fully legible on the card, without cluttering the layout.

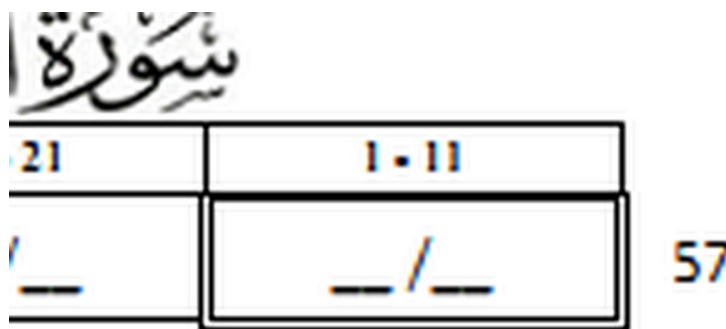


Figure 4: the double-bordered rectangle marks the start of hizb 57

For “Warsh” readers

The double-bordered rectangle marks the box where a new hizb begins; that hizb’s number is written in the margin, level with the row concerned.

Students and teachers who think in terms of hizb — often the case in the “Warsh” reading — can therefore keep tracking their progress in hizb, while enjoying the clarity of the division by surah.

3.6 Validating an objective

What the teacher does

5. The student recites the section corresponding to the current box.
6. If the section is correctly recited, the teacher writes the date of recitation in the box: the objective is validated.
7. If the objective is not met, the box stays blank and a new deadline is agreed with the student.
8. After two consecutive objectives are missed, a discussion is arranged with the parents in order to understand the obstacle and find a solution.
9. Once every box of a surah is validated, the student recites the surah in full: the teacher then dates the end-of-line box.

These end-of-line validations are consolidation points: they ensure the student is not merely stringing isolated sections together, but has mastered the whole before going further.

What the parents do

- Have the week’s objective revised at home, every day, for a short spell.
- Check the card after every lesson: a dated box means the objective was met, an empty box means it was carried over.
- Sign the note in the home-school notebook before the next recitation.

3.7 Progression and levels

There are six levels; each level has its own card. The cards look alike and differ only in the objectives to be met: the higher the level, the more ambitious the objective.

The level is independent of the class and of how long the student has attended. A class may therefore bring together students holding cards of different levels. It remains more practical, however, to group students of the same category in one class: “beginner” for level 1, “intermediate” for levels 2 and 3, “advanced” for levels 4, 5 and 6.

Whenever the annual objective is met, the student is given a higher-level card with a new objective. A reward is presented along with the new card, to mark the achievement and provide motivation for the new challenge.

For particularly gifted students, who find learning easier, more ambitious objectives may be set on an individual basis.



Figure 5: the six cards and their colour code

Summary table

Category	Card	Prerequisite	Objective for the year	Cumulative	Per week	Per day	Learning
Beginner	1	Syllabic reading acquired	Hizb 60 “Sabbih”	1 hizb	3 to 5 lines	—	In class, then at home
Intermediate	2	1 hizb (Sabbih)	Hizb 59 “‘Amma”	2 hizb	3 to 5 lines	< 1 line	At home (semi-autonomous)
Intermediate	3	2 hizb (‘Amma)	Hizb 58 and 57 “Tabāraka”	4 hizb	7 to 10 lines	< 2 lines	At home (autonomous)
Advanced	4	4 hizb (Tabāraka)	Hizb 56 to 53 “Adh-Dhāriyāt”	8 hizb	15 to 20 lines	< 3 lines	At home
Advanced	5	8 hizb (Adh-Dhāriyāt)	Hizb 52 to 49 “Ash-Shūrā”	12 hizb	15 to 20 lines	< 3 lines	At home
Advanced	6	12 hizb (Ash-Shūrā)	Hizb 48 to 45 “Yāsîn”	16 hizb	15 to 20 lines	< 3 lines	At home

Table 1: objectives set by the recitation card, by level

3.8 The levels one by one

Level 1 — beginner

This level is for beginners: first-year students, or students with reading difficulties. Its objective is the memorisation of the last hizb of the Qur’an — no. 60, “Sabbih” — together with the acquisition of semi-autonomous learning. It requires a minimum command of syllabic reading.

Card no. 1 carries the whole of hizb 60 on its own. It is read in two stages, reflecting the uneven length of the surahs in this hizb:

- the right-hand half gathers the twenty shortest surahs, from “An-Nâs” to “Ad-Duhâ”. Each fits in a single box: the objective for the week is then a whole surah;
- the left-hand half carries the longer surahs, from “Al-Layl” to “Al-A‘lâ”, divided into verse ranges as on the cards of the following levels.

The reading direction is printed on the card: first the right-hand half from top to bottom, then the left-hand half from right to left and from top to bottom. Reading therefore runs from right to left, as on the cards of the following levels.

—	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 10-15 1-10	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 11-21 1-11	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ
—	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 6-8 4-6 1-4	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 10-19 1-10	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ
—	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 19-30 7-15 1-7	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 30-19 1-10	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ
—	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 20-26 10-20 1-10		سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ
—	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ 22-30 16-22 10-16 1-10		سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ	سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ

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Figure 6: back of card no. 1 — the whole of hizb 60 “Sabbih”

Learning first takes place in class, through group reading. There is no strictly fixed monthly objective: progress follows the student’s advance in mastering reading. The objectives may in fact be tackled in any order — group learning may, for instance, begin at “Wa-Attîni” and work towards “An-Nâs”. Short sections are thus covered, which eases memorisation and puts students on an equal footing, since some already know the briefest surahs.

In the second half of the year, once the student has gained a degree of autonomy, learning at home is introduced with the parents’ active participation. A weekly objective of 3 to 5 lines is then set, that is less than one line a day, and the sections covered are the longer surahs — those in the left-hand half of the card.

A photocopy of the section to be learnt, in a suitable format, is handed out to students to make reading and memorisation easier. Revision of the accumulated sections takes place in class, individually, in pairs or in groups.

For those starting from scratch

Most students already know the shortest surahs when they arrive. For those genuinely starting from scratch — a less frequent case — two preparatory cards provide a first foothold before moving on to card no. 1.

- The first covers the surahs from “An-Nâs” to “Al-Fîl”.
- The second continues from “Al-Humaza” to “Ad-Duhâ”.

These cards take the twenty short surahs from the right-hand half of card no. 1, but break them down verse by verse or into small groups of verses. They have another distinctive feature: the boxes are not dated but simply ticked. The date is written only at the end of a surah, at the full recitation, before moving on to the next.

Once these two cards are complete, the student moves on to the standard card no. 1.

سُورَةُ الْفَاتِحَةِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْمَائِدَةِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْكَافِرَاتِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1-2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5-6</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْمَاعُونِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4-5</td><td>6-7</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْغَاشِيَةِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / —	1	2	3	4	5						1	2	3	4	5						1-2	3	4	5-6					1	2	3	4-5	6-7						1	2	3	4	5						سُورَةُ النَّازِعَاتِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2-3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td><td>6</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْحَاقِقِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْجِنِّ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْبُرُجِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / — سُورَةُ الْفُرْقَانِ <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <tr><td>1</td><td>2</td><td>3</td><td>4</td></tr> <tr><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td><td> </td></tr> </table> — / —	1	2-3	4	5	6						1	2	3	4					1	2	3				1	2	3				1	2	3	4				
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Figure 7: first preparatory card (from “An-Nâs” to “Al-Fil”)

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Figure 8: second preparatory card (from “Al-Humaza” to “Ad-Duhâ”)

Level 2 — intermediate

This level is for intermediate students, with semi-autonomous reading and learning at the start of the year. Its objective is the memorisation of hizb no. 59 (“Amma”), together with the acquisition of fully autonomous learning — a cumulative total of 2 hizb.

This level requires level 1 to have been validated. Learning takes place mainly at home, with the parents’ active participation; the monthly objective is set at one eighth of a hizb (one “thumun”).

In the second half of the year, once the student has gained full autonomy, learning at home continues without the parents’ active participation; from then on they focus on monitoring. The weekly objective is set at 3 to 5 lines, that is less than one line a day. Revision takes place in class, individually, in pairs or in groups.

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Figure 9: back of the level 2 card

Level 3 — intermediate

This level is for intermediate students with autonomous reading and learning. Its objective is the memorisation of hizb no. 58 and 57 ("Tabâraka"), together with command of the hizb acquired at earlier levels — a cumulative total of 4 hizb.

This level requires level 2 to have been validated. Learning takes place exclusively at home, autonomously. The monthly objective is set at one quarter of a hizb (one "rub"), which corresponds to a weekly objective of 7 to 10 lines, that is less than two lines a day. Revision takes place in class, individually, in pairs or in groups.

سُورَةُ الْفَاتِحَةِ <table border="1"> <tr> <td>39-52</td> <td>21-39</td> <td>1-21</td> </tr> <tr> <td>—/—</td> <td>—/—</td> <td>—/—</td> </tr> </table>	39-52	21-39	1-21	—/—	—/—	—/—	سُورَةُ الْمَائِدَةِ <table border="1"> <tr> <td>21-30</td> <td>11-21</td> <td>1-11</td> </tr> <tr> <td>—/—</td> <td>—/—</td> <td>—/—</td> </tr> </table>	21-30	11-21	1-11	—/—	—/—	—/—
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Figure 10: back of the level 3 card

Level 4 — advanced

This level is for advanced students, with good reading and a good capacity for autonomous learning. Its objective is the memorisation of hizb no. 56 to 53 — hizb "Qâla famâ khatbukum", Surah "Adh-Dhâriyât" — together with command of the hizb acquired at earlier levels, a cumulative total of 8 hizb.

This level requires level 3 to have been validated. Learning takes place exclusively at home, autonomously. The monthly objective is set at half a hizb (one "nisf"), which corresponds to a weekly objective of 15 to 20 lines, that is less than three lines a day. Revision takes place in class, individually, in pairs or in groups.

☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْفَتَحَةِ	سُورَةُ الْحَجَرِ	سُورَةُ الْخُلُقِ	سُورَةُ الدَّارِ الْاِسْأَاتِ	53
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْحَجَرِ	سُورَةُ الْفَتَحَةِ	سُورَةُ الْخُلُقِ	سُورَةُ الدَّارِ الْاِسْأَاتِ	54
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْفَتَحَةِ	سُورَةُ الْحَجَرِ	سُورَةُ الْخُلُقِ	سُورَةُ الدَّارِ الْاِسْأَاتِ	55
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْحَجَرِ	سُورَةُ الْفَتَحَةِ	سُورَةُ الْخُلُقِ	سُورَةُ الدَّارِ الْاِسْأَاتِ	56
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْفَتَحَةِ	سُورَةُ الْحَجَرِ	سُورَةُ الْخُلُقِ	سُورَةُ الدَّارِ الْاِسْأَاتِ	57

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Figure 11: back of the level 4 card

Level 5 — advanced

This level is for advanced students, with good reading and a good capacity for autonomous learning. Its objective is the memorisation of hizb no. 52 to 49 — hizb “Ilayhi”, Surah “Ash-Shûrâ” — together with command of the hizb acquired at earlier levels, a cumulative total of 12 hizb.

This level requires level 4 to have been validated. The arrangements are identical to those of level 4: exclusively autonomous learning at home, half a hizb per month, 15 to 20 lines per week, revision in class.

☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْيُونُسَ	سُورَةُ الْيُونُسَ	59
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الدَّجَانِ	سُورَةُ الْيُونُسَ	50
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْيُونُسَ	سُورَةُ الدَّجَانِ	51
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الدَّجَانِ	سُورَةُ الْيُونُسَ	52
☐	—/—	سُورَةُ الْيُونُسَ	سُورَةُ الدَّجَانِ	52

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Figure 12: back of the level 5 card

Level 6 — advanced

This level is for advanced students, with good reading and a good capacity for autonomous learning. Its objective is the memorisation of hizb no. 48 to 45 — hizb “Wa mâ anzalnâ”, Surah “Yâsîn” — together with command of the hizb acquired at earlier levels, a cumulative total of 16 hizb. It closes the programme and reaches the stated objective: the last quarter of the Qur’an.

This level requires level 5 to have been validated. The arrangements are identical to those of levels 4 and 5: exclusively autonomous learning at home, half a hizb per month, 15 to 20 lines per week, revision in class.

سُورَةُ الصَّافَّاتِ	سُورَةُ يٰسِينَ
☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/-	-/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- 45
سُورَةُ الْحٰجِّاتِ	سُورَةُ الصَّافَّاتِ
☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/-	-/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- 46
سُورَةُ الزُّمَرِ	سُورَةُ الزُّمَرِ
☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/-	-/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- 47
سُورَةُ الْاٰنْكَارِ	سُورَةُ الْاٰنْكَارِ
☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/-	-/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- 48
سُورَةُ قُلُوبِ	سُورَةُ قُلُوبِ
☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/-	-/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- ☐ -/- 49

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Figure 13: back of the level 6 card

4. The monitoring tools

The recitation card says where the student is going. Two further tools say where the student stands, week after week, and open a channel between teacher and parents.

4.1 The recitation and behaviour record card

This card stays with the student all year. It carries the student's details and a grid in which the teacher records, at each session, how the recitation went and, where needed, a remark on behaviour.

Figure 14: recitation and behaviour record card

The key

Four icons are enough to describe a session:

Figure 15: key to the record icons

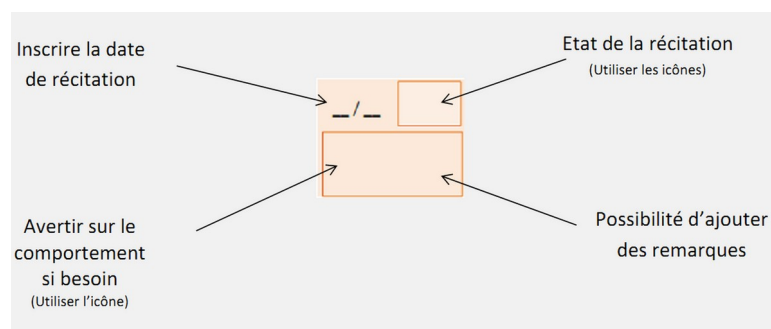


Figure 16: anatomy of a box on the record card

4.2 The memorisation homework table

Each row of this table sets a portion of a surah to be learnt, or revised, for the next recitation session. The teacher uses it to assess the student's recitation and behaviour in class.

The table must be signed

Parents check and sign the teacher's assessment before the next session. That signature is not a formality: it is what guarantees the work instruction has travelled from school to home.

[illegible]

Figure 17: Holy Qur'an memorisation homework table

4.3 The parents' weekly routine

Four things to do, every week

10. After the lesson: open the recitation card and see whether the week's box has been dated.
11. Read the day's row in the homework table: which surah, which verses.
12. Have the student work at home, every day, for a short spell and without pressure — a quarter of an hour is enough for beginners.
13. Sign the teacher's assessment before the next session.

Consulting these tools regularly allows parents to keep informed, at any time and continuously, of the student's performance and progress, as well as of their conduct in class.

5. Course organisation

The aim of the programme is the memorisation of the Qur'an in accordance with the rules of tajwîd. This calls for taking into account what has been learnt as objectives are met, and for planning regular revision to consolidate it throughout the year. It is also important to give the student keys to understanding the surahs being memorised. The lesson is therefore divided into four subjects.

Subject	Share	Day	Duration
Recitation	40 %	Sunday	A full session (≈ 2 effective hours)
Revision	30 %	Wednesday	Half a session (≈ 1 effective hour)
Reading improvement	20 %	Wednesday	Half a session (≈ 1 effective hour)
Understanding the Qur'anic text	10 %	Wednesday	Up to half an hour

Table 2: the typical week

5.1 Recitation

The aim of this lesson is to recite new sections and meet the objectives set at the start of the year. The lesson is given over entirely to reciting sections learnt at home; the recitation card is used for greater effectiveness. The number of lines to learn depends on the level of the card.

New sections are read through individually with the student. They are taught in “Warsh”, so as to keep consistency across levels. If some passages were previously learnt in the “Hafs” reading, no issue is made of it, but new sections are approached in “Warsh”.

For level 1 beginners, learning proceeds by repetition in class; work towards autonomy begins in the second half of the year, when longer surahs are taken up. Acquiring this autonomy prepares the move to the next level: the student first goes through a semi-autonomous phase at level 2 — learning now happens at home, with the parents' help — before gradually gaining full independence at level 3 and beyond. With the parents' involvement, the student may use interactive materials at home (audio CDs, online interactive Qur'an) to ease this transition.

- The lesson is scheduled on Sunday, the busiest day, and lasts a full session, that is about two effective hours.
- For classes made up of beginners, recitation also takes place on Wednesday, given the particular nature of their learning: group learning, less revision time, autonomy still being acquired.

5.2 Revision

The aim of this lesson is to consolidate what has been learnt and the accumulated total. Revision is done by reading or reciting individually, in pairs or collectively. The lesson is scheduled on Wednesday and lasts half a session, that is about one effective hour.

5.3 Reading improvement

The aim of this lesson is to improve reading and learn the rules of tajwîd. It draws on theory lessons and practical work. For beginners, the teacher will use a syllabic method — “Al-Baghdâdiyya” or “An-Nûrâniyya” — for better results. The lesson is scheduled on Wednesday and lasts half a session, that is about one effective hour.

For classes made up of beginners:

- this lesson also takes place on Sunday, given the particular nature of their learning;
- early-year sessions may be given over to learning to read by the syllabic method;
- improvement of Qur'anic reading will be carried out alongside recitation or group learning.

About the “An-Nûrâniyya” method

This is a well-known method, particularly suited to learning to read the Qur’an. It differs from the “Al-Baghdâdiyya” method in that it familiarises the student with certain subtleties of Qur’anic script that do not exist in classical Arabic: “mudûd”, the form of the “yâ”, the “muqatta’a” letters, subtleties of the “râ”, and “imâla”.

5.4 Understanding the Qur’anic text

The aim of this lesson is to acquaint the student with the overall meaning of the surahs encountered along the way. The teacher sets out the overall meaning and the vocabulary used; a word list with translations is handed out to students.

The lesson is scheduled on Wednesday, at the end of the reading improvement session, and lasts up to half an hour.

At the teacher’s initiative, this lesson may be extended with teaching on the merits of the Qur’an and of knowledge in general: invocations, short “hadith”, Qur’anic passages, and the names of Allah, exalted be He.

6. Conclusion

This methodology, built on objective-based teaching, is meant to be both structuring and demanding. Structuring, because it rests on a timetable of objectives defined by the recitation card. Demanding, because it relies on learning at home and requires daily monitoring.

But it can only work through the strong commitment of everyone involved: the student, the teacher and above all the parents. Parents indeed play a decisive part in monitoring learning at home. This is a new paradigm: the home is the place of learning, and the lesson a space for validating and consolidating what has been learnt at home. The lesson becomes a landmark on which parents rely in order to take part in meeting the student's objectives.

It is a demand equal to the ambitions set out. We believe this way of approaching learning is the one that allows the greatest effectiveness, for better results.

This is but one stage in the absorbing and rewarding study of the Qur'an and its sciences. May Allah, exalted be He, guide us and allow us to be among those close to Him!

Appendix A · A note for parents

A page to detach and keep to hand.

Reading the card in ten seconds

- The card is read from right to left and from top to bottom.
- One block = one surah. One box = one week.
- The figures above the box are the numbers of the verses to memorise.
- A dated box = objective met. An empty box = objective carried over.
- The double-bordered rectangle marks the start of a hizb; its number is in the margin.

The expected pace at home

The principle is regularity, not intensity. A quarter of an hour every day is better than one long session on Saturday.

- Level 1: 3 to 5 lines per week, with a parent's help.
- Level 2: 3 to 5 lines per week, then autonomously.
- Level 3: 7 to 10 lines per week, autonomously.
- Levels 4 to 6: 15 to 20 lines per week, autonomously.

When to be concerned

Two consecutive missed objectives trigger a meeting with the teacher. Do not wait for that signal: if the student is stuck on a surah, tell the teacher at the very next session.

Appendix B · Licence

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